viewing of Israeli forces in the territories, interminable talk shows dominated by anti-Zionists, major flare-ups in the Gaza strip, and an outpouring of literature comparing apartheid South Africa to Israel, continue to undermine the idea of the Jewish state and fuel the call for BDS.

This was already evident in the 2006 Operation Cast Lead and Israel's incursion into the Gaza Strip in early January 2009 in response to the barrage of rockets aimed at Israeli population centres. At a mass rally in support of the Palestinian cause in Lenasia, a Johannesburg suburb with a large Muslim population, South Africa's then-Deputy Foreign Minister, Fatima Hajaig, told a "wildly cheering" audience that the United States and the West were controlled by "Jewish money power." A fellow speaker said that "the Zionists in South Africa must be kicked out of the shores of South Africa." Shortly before, Hajaig had summoned the Israeli ambassador to her office where in his own words he was "bashed very, very badly." Hajaig's outburst at the rally was condemned by the government and she received a "dressing down" from Kgalema Motlanthe, Thabo Mbeki's short-lived successor as president. Hajaig was forced to apologize for "any hurt" she might have caused the Jewish community. Yet it needs to be noted that her hostility to Israel was shared by the ANC members of parliament's Foreign Affairs committee. In a three-hour appearance before a largely hostile committee, Israel's unfortunate ambassador experienced "the same tongue lashing" that he had in his earlier meeting with the deputy minister.[43]

The pressure persisted well after the Gaza incursion, with Tutu and other prominent figures regularly castigating Israel's actions. In 2010 the University of Johannesburg severed ties with Ben-Gurion University of the Negev, and in 2012 Deputy Foreign Minister Ebrahim Ebrahim called on South Africans not to visit Israel. During "Israel Apartheid Week" in 2013 protestors, led by the South African chapter of the international BDS movement, disrupted a concert at the University of the Witwatersrand, Johannesburg, featuring a visiting Israeli pianist. Later in the year demonstrators chanted "Dubula e Juda" (Shoot the Jews, in Zulu) outside a concert intended to compensate for the earlier disruption.[44]

Disturbingly, hostility to Israel has increasingly descended into blatant Jew-hatred, with the dissemination of antisemitic literature, and increasing verbal abuse of Jews and vandalism of Jewish property. Predictably, the temperature rose still further during Operation Protective Edge in August 2014. All the old canards were heard, with observers describing Israeli actions in Gaza as genocide. Mass marches were peppered with ugly outbursts of classic antisemitism. Blade Nzimande, the Minister of Education, told a mass meeting in Johannesburg that the conflict was one of "western

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